



Welcome Friends!

We welcome you to worship wherever you may be in your faith's journey. We strive to live in the way of Jesus Christ, sharing God's love on a daily basis regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history.

If you are new to our church community,
please fill out some information about yourself in the "visitor" tab of our website.
You can learn a little bit more about us, and get yourself added to our email information lists.

Greeting

Lighting of the Advent Wreath

Candle Lighters: The Hicks Family

Song of Response:

Peace, Peace, Peace on Earth
Peace, peace, peace on earth and good will to all
this is a time for joy
this is a time for love
now let us all sing together
of peace, peace, peace on earth

Prayers

Sharing Joys and Concerns

Morning Prayer

(adapted from Touch Holiness, ed. Ruth C. Duck & Maren C. Tirabassi)

Holy Center of this most holy season, Jesus, child and ruler, all our stars point to your birth; all our wanderings come home to you; all our griefs and delights find a place in the stable where you choose to transform poverty and pain and loneliness and rejection. Your light shines in our lives; your peace embraces our anger, sorrow, and loss; your life opens us to new discovery of our most intimate selves and of our neighbors, however we may find them – as poor as shepherds, as foreign as magi, as thoughtless as innkeepers, as helpless as infants. In your humble birth we discover your everlasting majesty and grace. We welcome you and offer you our thanks and praise. Amen.

Silent Prayers

All Earth is Waiting

Alberto Taulé

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The Lord's Prayer

inclusive

**Our Creator, God in heaven, hallowed be thy name.
Thy kin-dom^{*} come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread.
And forgive us our trespasses as we forgive those who trespass against us.
Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kin-dom and the power and the glory forever. Amen.**

^{*}*Kin-dom represents a hope for God's realm where we are all in community with one another.*

Children's Message

Jenia Strom

Passing the Peace

Congregational Hymn

Led by Alex Rack and Anders Nelson

It Came Upon the Midnight Clear

The United Methodist Hymnal

Edmund H. Sears (1859)

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It came upon the midnight clear, that glorious song of old,
from angels bending near the earth to touch their harps of gold:
"Peace on the earth, good will to men, from heaven's all-gracious King."
The world in solemn stillness lay, to hear the angels sing.

Still through the cloven skies they come with peaceful wings unfurled,
and still their heavenly music floats o'er all the weary world;
above its sad and lowly plains, they bend on hovering wing,
and ever o'er its Babel sounds the blessed angels sing.

And ye, beneath life's crushing load, whose forms are bending low,
who toil along the climbing way with painful steps and slow,
look now! for glad and golden hours come swiftly on the wing.
O rest beside the weary road, and hear the angels sing!

For lo! the days are hastening on, by prophet seen of old,
when with the ever-circling years shall come the time foretold
when peace shall over all the earth its ancient splendors fling,
and the whole world send back the song which now the angels sing.

Offertory

Performed by Anders Nelson

People Look East

Eleanor Farjeon, arr. Wayne Wold

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Scripture Lesson

Trevor Hicks

Isaiah 40:1-11

Message

"To Bring Peace"

Traveling Music

Performed by The Methodicals

A Long December

David Bryson, Adam Duritz, Charles Gillingham, Matthew Malley, Ben Mize, Daniel Vickrey as performed by Counting Crows

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The Methodicals:

Piano: Tim Siefkes

Drums: Mike Gunvalson

Electric Guitar: Mike Forrest

Backup Vocals: Julie Darlington

Lead vocals, harmonica, bass and acoustic guitar: Josh Espinosa

Benediction

Worship Personnel

Rev. Becky Sechrist, *Pastor*;

Jenia Strom, *Program Director of Children, Youth, and Families*

Alex Rack, *Choir Director*; Anders Nelson, *Organist*; Tim Siefkes and Josh Espinosa, *Contemporary Band Leaders*;

Nicholas Sabah, *Communion Steward*

Thank you to: Dean Ammerman, Pete Ketcham & Jessi Lindren for video production and Anders Nelson & Tim Siefkes for music production

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Announcements

Holding in prayer:

- **Deaths:** Betty Petit (*Annette Meier's step-mother*) on Nov. 30
- **Covid 19:** Arlyne Forsberg (*Diane Enge's mother*)
- **Prayers of Care:** Gary Claude (*Sue Claude's father*)
- **Receiving treatment for cancer:** Scott Christianson (*son-in-law of Mary Doelz*), Joan Ellison, Jordyn Meskan (*niece of Elaine Chadwick*), David Miller (*father of Kevin Miller*), Carol Spearman, Wanda (*friend of Kim Neal*)
- **Healthcare workers:** Rene Cronquist, Deb Diko, Emma Dolphin, Andrea Ghizoni, Maggie Kappelman, Chloe Kennedy-Abdella, Quinn Kennedy-Abdella, Erinn Kennedy-Heldt, Paula Kocken, Kayla Hicks, Trevor Hicks, Peter Johnson, Sue Johnson, Dan Nelson, Fred Peterson, Amy Ralph, D.R. Schroeder
- **Educators:** Beth Anderson, Jill Carlton, Joy Collman, Jason Emrick, Hayley Forrest, Rachel Hansberry, Tori Holtz, Allison Jessee, Tanya Ketcham, Peggy Kirkpatrick, Rita Miller, Kim Moren, Matthew Palombo, Alex Rack, Eric Strom, Meredith Webb, Marisa Zimmerman
- **Partnership Families:** The Dauds and Omars

Toy Drive Donations Needed

During the 4 Tuesdays before Christmas, Food Shelf Parents are able to select toys for their children, ranging from babies to teenagers. Parents may choose a toy (ranging from baby toys to dolls to hot wheels to table foosball to hair dryers and clock radios), a stocking stuffer, and a hat or gloves for each of their children. We also provide gift bags and wrapping paper. All this is made possible by the generosity of members of Minnehaha. *Every year, parents respond with "Thank you, thank you, thank you!" and "Oh my gosh, these present are so nice!" and "Can I really get a hat and gloves for each of my children?"* There are three ways you can help with this mission:

- Buy toys, hats, and gloves- as our office hours are limited a great time to drop off toys is during MinneHarvest. To arrange another drop off time contact Renee Beymer
- Write a check to the church (put Toys in the memo line) or give through our Donate button on the website and designate it for Christmas Toys

With your help Good Things will, indeed, continue to Happen Here